

THE REALITY OF MIGRATION FROM WEST BENGAL

Sabar Institute surveyed over 7,500 migrant households and returnees in urban and rural Panshkura, conducted by 100+ student surveyors from Panskura Banamali College between 27 July and 10 August 2025

REASON FOR MIGRATION

62.87% cited better employment as the main reason, while 9.5% mentioned education.

HARASSMENT AND DISCRIMINATION

Workplace issues (19.89%) and housing discrimination (15.94%) were most reported, followed by language-related harassment (14.09%).

EDUCATIONAL PROFILE OF MIGRANTS

Over 51% had only completed 10th or 12th standard, indicating many discontinue education to migrate for work — a sign of distress migration.

USE OF REMITTANCES

25% of households used remittances for food and 18% for healthcare, showing migration sustains basic needs rather than discretionary spending.

IMPACT ON EDUCATION

60.23% were students before migrating, suggesting migration contributes to *high dropout rates* in West Bengal.